



NEWCOMERS TO THE AMERICAS



The Europeans who began arriving in North America at the beginning of the 17th century were traders and settlers as well as soldier-conquerors. At first, the contact between them and the people already living there, whom they called Indians, was friendly. The Native Americans showed the newcomers how to hunt, fish, and farm in a land of plenty. In return for their help and animal furs, the Native Americans were given objects such as knives, needles, fish hooks, and cloth. But before long, the settlers were taking more and more land for themselves, and trying to change the ways of the Native Americans.

Warm furs from the forest animals of North America were taken back to Europe and sold for high prices.

European weapons, tools, and machines completely changed hunting and warfare for Native Americans.

European cloth was prized for its bright colors and silkiness.

